

first character of each line as a “carriage control” character, which is not printed but may cause some action such as a page eject or overprinting. When a textfile is used to represent a particular device, the program must obey the conventions for using that device.

Textfiles may be accessed through the predeclared file procedures `Get` and `Put`. This can, of course, be quite cumbersome as these procedures are defined for single-character manipulation. To illustrate, suppose we have a natural number stored in a variable `x` and wish to write it on the file output. Note that the pattern of characters denoting the decimal representation of the value will be quite different from that denoting the value written as a Roman numeral (see Program 4.9). But as we are usually interested in decimal notation, it appears sensible to offer built-in, standard, transformation procedures that translate abstract numbers (from whatever computer-internal representation is used) into sequences of decimal digits and vice versa.

The two predeclared procedures `Read` and `Write` are thereby extended in several ways to facilitate the analysis and the formation of textfiles.

12.A. The Standard Files Input and Output

The standard textfiles `Input` and `Output` usually represent the standard I/O media of a computer system (such as the keyboard and the video display). Hence, they are the principal communication line between the computer system and its human user.

Because these two files are used very frequently, they are considered as “default values” in textfile operations when the textfile `F` is not explicitly indicated. That is

<code>Write(Ch)</code>	=	<code>Write(Output,Ch)</code>
<code>Read(Ch)</code>	=	<code>Read(Input,Ch)</code>
<code>Writeln</code>	=	<code>WriteLn(Output)</code> (See Section 12.B.)
<code>Readln</code>	=	<code>ReadLn(Input)</code> (See Section 12.B.)
<code>Eof</code>	=	<code>Eof(Input)</code> (See Section 12.B.)
<code>Eoln</code>	=	<code>Eoln(Input)</code> (See Section 12.B.)
<code>Page</code>	=	<code>Page(Output)</code> (See Section 12.D.)